

edit Cron tables and to display or remove Cron tables. Let us now look at how these options are used, one by one.

We can display Cron table contents on standard output by specifying the `-l` option with the `crontab` command. Given below are Cron table contents for user `'tom'`:

```
$ echo $USER
tom

$ crontab -l
# Check disk usage every week day at 11:30 PM.
30 23 * * 1-5 /home/tom/check_disk_usage.sh
```

We can also see Cron table contents of another user by providing the user's name with the `-u` option. Please note that the user must be privileged to use the `-u` option. Let us display the contents of the Cron table of the users `'tom'` and `'jerry'`:

```
[root]# echo $USER
root

[root]# crontab -l -u tom
# Check disk usage every week day at 11:30 PM.
30 23 * * 1-5 /home/tom/check_disk_usage.sh

[root]# crontab -l -u jerry
# Run build script every week day at 12:00 AM.
0 0 * * 1-5 /home/jerry/shipbuilder
```

By using the `-r` option, we can remove the Cron table of the user; so let us do so for the user `'tom'`:

```
$ echo $USER
tom

$ crontab -l
# Check disk usage every week day at 11:30 PM.
30 23 * * 1-5 /home/tom/check_disk_usage.sh

$ crontab -r

$ crontab -l
no crontab for tom
```

We can also remove the Cron table of another user by providing the user's name with the `-u` option. Remember that you must be privileged to use the `-u` option. Now, let us remove the Cron table of user `'jerry'`:

```
[root]# echo $USER
root

[root]# crontab -u jerry -l
# Run build script every week day
```

```
0 0 * * 1-5 /home/jerry/buildscript.sh
```

```
[root]# crontab -u jerry -r
```

```
[root]# crontab -u jerry -l
no crontab for jerry
```

The `-i` option modifies the behaviour of the `-r` option, and prompts the user for a `'(y/n)'` option before the actual removal of the Cron table. Let us look at an example:

```
$ crontab -l
# Check disk usage every week day at 11:30 PM.
30 23 * * 1-5 /home/tom/check_disk_usage.sh

$ crontab -ri
crontab: really delete tom's crontab? (y/n) y

$ crontab -l
no crontab for tom
```

So far we have seen how to display the contents of a Cron table and how to remove Cron tables. Now let us look at how to create and edit Cron tables. Let us discuss the various ways to define Cron tables, with examples.

The `-e` option of the `crontab` command enables editing of Cron tables. When the `'crontab -e'` command is entered on the shell prompt, a file is opened in the default text editor, which the user can use to create or update the Cron table. The example below will give you a better idea about this:

```
$ crontab -l
no crontab for tom

$ crontab -e
no crontab for tom - using an empty one
```



Note: After displaying the above message, the system's default editor will be opened, in which the user can create or edit the Cron table.

```
crontab: installing new crontab
```



Note: The above message will be displayed after the creation of the Cron table.

We have updated the Cron table. Now we can verify it by executing the `crontab -l` command:

```
$ crontab -l
# Check disk usage every week day at 11:30 PM.
30 23 * * 1-5 /home/tom/check_disk_usage.sh
```